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such as Jimmy Choo and Armani. Gupta says they have adopted a “capital-heavy approach” to acquire brands. Today, the conglomerate has over 50 international brands in the luxury business. Apart from that, the presence in real estate—through its retail luxury destinations, Jio World Plaza and One Jio Drive—has added heft. “They are the LVMH of India with a portfolio that cuts across brands and real estate,” he adds.

I**N ITS ANNUAL** report for FY25, Reliance said the overall retail business across formats had a gross revenue of ₹3.3 lakh crore. “Reliance Retail is India’s largest fashion and lifestyle retailer. It operates multiple retail formats tailored to meet varied consumer preferences across segments, providing a world-class shopping experience,” it stated. On the premium brands part, the business “enriched its portfolio with new brand partnerships while focusing on global expan-

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GRAND LIVING
The Chankaya in New Delhi is home to globally celebrated luxury brands, including Hermès, Chanel, Rolex, Saint Laurent, Tiffany & Co, Ralph Lauren, and many more.

sion of owned intellectual properties.” Among the luxury brands in its stable are Valentino, Tiffany, Bottega Veneta, Giorgio Armani, Zegna, Abu Jani Sandeep Khosla, Burberry, Diesel, Satya Paul, Steve Madden, and Bally.

Clearly, there is an Indian way to luxury. Som says consumers here are rational buyers and look for value-for-money. “If you remove cosmetics, perfume, or some specific wine and champagne or watches that are not made here, Indian consumers are not lured by the luxury world,” he explains. He emphasises the point that Western haute couture will not lure Indian consumers. Given there is no inheritance tax here, consumers spend on their home, education, weddings, travel, and save. “There is really no urgency to buy luxury goods for status seeking or just to show off.”

He thinks the move into luxury by the three conglomerates is a logical step. “It is based on the assumption that Indian consumers would spend on luxury goods as the GDP/capita of India rises, as it did